COMMUNICATION

4 Communication Tips for Couples

Most arguments aren't about what they're about. The real conversation is buried underneath. Here's how to get there.

1. Pause before your mouth moves.

When you feel flooded — heart racing, thoughts blurring — pause. Three slow breaths. Your prefrontal cortex goes offline when your nervous system is activated. Give it time to come back online.

2. Name the feeling. Not the blame.

'I feel lonely when...' lands differently than 'You never...' One opens a door. The other puts your partner on trial. Own your emotional experience without making it a verdict on theirs.

3. Listen to understand, not respond.

Most couples listen while preparing their rebuttal. Try this instead: listen with the only goal of understanding. Then reflect back what you heard before adding your perspective.

4. Repair early and often.

Healthy couples don't avoid conflict — they repair quickly. A genuine 'I was out of line' restores safety faster than winning the argument ever could.

Connection is built in the repair.

Save this for your next hard conversation.